Hannah Kim

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U.S. Citizen
https://hannahkim-econ.github.io/

RESEARCH FIELDS

Environmental Economics, Development Economics, Agricultural Economics, Health Economics

EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
Ph.D. in Agricultural and Consumer Economics — Expected May 2027

Cornell University
M.S. in Applied Economics and Management — Aug 2021

Ewha Womans University, South Korea
B.A. in Economics — Aug 2019
Dual Major in International Development and Cooperation Studies

REFERENCES

Sarah A. Janzen
Associate Professor
Dept. of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois
sjanzen@illinois.edu

Andrew B. Hultgren
Assistant Professor
Dept. of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois
ahultgr@illinois.edu

Hope C. Michelson
Professor
Dept. of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois
hopecm@illinois.edu

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Replanting Under Risk: Weather Shocks and Portfolio Choice in Perennial Agriculture"
(Solo Authored) *Draft available upon request*

This paper studies how weather risk shapes agricultural adaptation when farmers in developing countries make long-lived investments. The analysis applies a standard portfolio-choice framework from finance to a perennial agricultural setting, linking farmers' land allocation to crop-specific expected returns and return variance. Coffee and khat are both cash crops that compete for land in Ethiopia, but differ in their sensitivity to weather and their risk-return profiles. Combining a rich, geolocated household panel with detailed hourly gridded weather data, I estimate crop-specific weather-profit relationships and use recent weather histories to construct weather-induced mean profits and profit variances. These measures are then related to the coffee share of coffee-khat land. Coffee profits are highly sensitive to extreme heat, but farmers adjust gradually within coffee land rather than an immediate exit from coffee cultivation. Higher coffee profit variance predicts a lower coffee share, while higher khat profit variance predicts a higher coffee share. Higher mean predicted khat profit also predicts a lower coffee share. The results suggest that long-run adaptation depends not only on average profitability but also on the stability of returns to long-lived agricultural investments.

WORKING PAPERS

"Global Extreme Weather and Early Childhood Undernourishment"
Hannah Kim, Andrew Hultgren, Sarah Janzen

Provides global causal evidence on how early-life weather shocks affect child growth, combining DHS anthropometric data for more than 1.2 million children across 57 low- and middle-income countries with high-resolution ERA5 weather data to reconstruct daily exposure histories from conception through the survey date. Estimates how the effects of temperature and precipitation vary across developmental stages, distinguishing prenatal exposure from shocks experienced after birth. Drought and extreme cold during gestation have persistent adverse effects on child growth, with lower height-for-age observed at ages three to five, while heavy rainfall becomes more consequential after birth.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Wildfire Damages in the United States"
Hannah Kim, Andrew Hultgren

Estimates the local economic impacts of wildfire exposure using U.S. county-level panel data and a population- and economic-activity-weighted measure of MODIS burned area that captures where fires occur within counties. Distributed-lag estimates show limited population responses, declines in unemployment consistent with post-fire reconstruction, and heterogeneous effects across high- and low-fire-frequency regions.

EXTENSION AND OUTREACH

"As U.S. Biofuel Demand Grows, Where Does Soybean Supply Expand?"
Hannah Kim, Jonathan Coppess, Ryan Goodrich, Andrew Hultgren
Draft article for *farmdoc daily*

SEMINAR AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Paper: *Replanting Under Risk: Weather Shocks and Portfolio Choice in Perennial Agriculture*

· AAEA Annual Meeting 2026

Paper: *Global Extreme Weather and Early Childhood Undernourishment*

· Midwest International Economic Development Conference (MWIEDC) 2026

· AERE Annual Summer Meeting 2025

· AAEA–WAEA Joint Annual Meeting 2025

· KDIS–World Bank DIME Development Impact Conference 2024

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

ACE Travel Grant 2024–2026
AAEA–WAEA Section Sponsored Travel Grant 2025
Jonathan Baldwin Turner Fellowship 2021–2023
3rd Place, Food Law and Policy Paper Competition, National Food Safety Information Service 2020
Euncheon Scholarship, Euncheon Scholarship Foundation, Korea 2020
Appenzeller Memorial Scholarship, International Foundation for Ewha Womans University, NY 2020
Creative Social Science Academy Award, Ewha Womans University 2017
Excellence Student Scholarship, DB Cultural Foundation, Korea 2017
National Full Scholarship, Korea 2014–2018

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant (Prof. Andrew Hultgren) 2023 – Present
University of Illinois

· Collaborated with private sector partners on data integration and empirical analysis of wildfire damages using county-level panel data.

Research Assistant (Prof. Henning Otte Hansen) 2018
Dept. of Food and Resource Economics (IFRO), University of Copenhagen & SEGES, Denmark

· Selected as a government-sponsored research fellow (Ministry of Agriculture, Republic of Korea).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

TA, ACE 264: Applied Statistical Methods and Data Analytics II Spring 2025, 2026
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
Teaching effectiveness: 4.2/5 (Spring 2025); 4.5/5 (Spring 2026, *Rated as Excellent*)

TA, ACE 251: The World Food Economy Fall 2022, Spring 2023
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

SERVICE

Referee

· Journal: Science Advances (AAAS), Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy (AEPP), UNCTAD
· Conference: Midwest International Economic Development Conference

University Service (UIUC)

· Department Courses and Curricula Committee 2026–2027
· Graduate Student Representative, College Courses and Curricula Committee (ACES) 2026–2027

SKILLS

Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, High-Performance Computing (HPC)